

Fasting Preserves Your Wineskin

Are you ready to hear more about not eating? I can always tell who is in a fast when I preach. Instead of groaning, they smirk.

Open to Romans 8:10. From there we will go to Matthew 9. In the early services, even though we are teaching on knowing His voice, the true voice of God, we are also going to connect that with extended areas of fasting.

Father, this is important to me. You have given us a key that carries power with it, by our own will, to shut our flesh down. As the Holy Spirit attempts to take that new nature and make us everything the Word says we are, and as our flesh resists it, there is something we can do. We can help in our own death.

The moment you are born again and receive that new nature, your flesh receives a death sentence. Some people live their whole lives without carrying it out, but every area of our lives that we throw away into something of no value has already been sentenced. God wants to bring us above all that by the operation of the new nature.

When I am so hungry for God that I want to help Him in this process, fasting is most effective. By fasting, you begin to execute the positional death of the flesh, and everything you are in Christ Jesus as a new creation can begin to come forward, especially in areas of the flesh that you have trouble controlling.

We began in Matthew 17, with the question of why that devil would not come out. Jesus was plain:

Because of your unbelief.

But He would not tell them the problem without also telling them what to do about it. He added prayer and fasting:

This kind goeth not out but by prayer and fasting.

The primary reason was unbelief. I know what prayer has to do with unbelief. As I pray in the Holy Ghost, the revelation gift unveils the mysteries of Christ. As I speak the Word, I release the authority and power to move mountains that He has made available to believers.

Fasting executes the position that the flesh has been declared to hold. Worship is different. Worship is your human spirit ministering to God. Everything else is to you and through you for various benefits or change, but worship is the one thing by which you literally minister to your Father.

God is Spirit, and He seeks such to worship Him. Without faith it is impossible to please Him, so you can please Him with faith, but you can minister to Him with worship.

It is strange that He desires this from me. It is hard for me to measure my own worth, as it is hard for you to measure yours. Chemically, you are worth only a few dollars. Eternally, there is no scale that can measure you.

He would not create you with such finality and then treat you cheaply. Your body was made out of something He created ages before, the dust of the earth, but not your spirit. He paused in your creation, reached inside Himself, and took something out that could not die. You were born of Him. Adam lost it, and then we were born of Him again.

That is the kind of love He loves you with.

Romans 8:10 says:

And if Christ be in you, the body is dead because of sin; but the Spirit is life because of righteousness.

If Christ is in you, then you qualify for this verse. Positionally, your body has been declared dead.

Two things happened when you were born again. You received a new spirit, but you kept the same body. Some of you have noticed that to your agony. Because you kept the same body, He gave a positional truth for it: death. Your body was declared dead, and your spirit was declared righteous and seated with Him.

The spirit there is your human spirit. Your human spirit is life, Zoe, God-kind life, because of righteousness.

It may not feel like your body is dead. It did not feel like it to me when I was first saved. My body still wanted the same pipe it smoked before. I threw away pipe after pipe. One was carved ivory from Japan, from my Navy days. I would smoke it on the way to church, hear holiness and hellfire preaching, then throw it out the window on the way home. I would not give it to somebody else and usher them into sin.

He provided a positional truth for the body: dead. I know my body wants to control me at times, but He prepared and declared a place for it called dead. Fasting helps me attain to that.

Fasting did Mahatma Gandhi, Buddha, and other religious men no spiritual good because there was no positional truth for them to execute. When they fasted, they got hungry. There was no born-again spirit with righteousness and life to enforce the body's death.

When you fast, even two or three days, there is a position you are attaining to. There is somewhere He put your body when you were born again, and that place is positionally called dead.

When you pray in tongues, speak His Word, meditate His Word, and thank God, He enforces your position of being seated in heavenly places with Christ Jesus through that new nature. When you fast, you execute the position your body has been declared to have: dead.

We thought we moved God because we fasted a certain number of days and suddenly He did something tremendous for us. Then we write a book, *How to Move God*. But God is not the one stuck.

If we are talking about sin, being born again is enough to execute total victory over sin. You do not need more than the new nature that emanates from your new spirit to checkmate anything your flesh wants to do and enforce its defeat. These things are not works. They assist you in your weakness to come to the place His grace says you are.

Praying in tongues is not works. The Holy Ghost bypassed the operation of your flesh so He could help you.

Fasting executes the positional truth your body has been declared. Whether in two- or three-day increments, with eating in between, eventually whatever was more alive than your spirit has to face its own death. One day it drops below the operation of your spirit, and the things God has for you begin to pour in.

Then people say, "My fasting moved God."

No. You lined up what could not receive into a position that could receive, and God got to be your Father.

Short fasts are highly effective. Even with a strenuous job, you can continue one- or two-day fasts until the ceiling is gone and you are free in a new operation of God.

Here you are, with flesh ceilinging you, and you are bouncing against it. Fast, pray, meditate, speak the Word, fast, pray, speak the Word. Finally the triumphant operation of your spirit rises above the ceiling of the flesh.

Wonderful things begin to happen.

When you fast, you are executing the positional truth that your body has been declared dead.

Would you like Jesus to prove that from His own words? Go to Matthew 9.

Matthew 9:14 says:

Then came to him the disciples of John, saying, Why do we and the Pharisees fast oft, but thy disciples fast not?

Jesus answered:

Can the children of the bridechamber mourn, as long as the bridegroom is with them?

Then:

But the days will come, when the bridegroom shall be taken from them, and then shall they fast.

Jesus was talking about the peculiar time between the two covenants. He was fulfilling the law, having been born under the law of a woman, but He was also preaching the principles of the kingdom of God.

Luke 16 says:

The law and the prophets were until John: since that time the kingdom of God is preached, and every man presseth into it.

When Jesus taught parables and said, "The kingdom of God is like," He was teaching new creation truths to spiritually dead men. No one could have the new life to understand what He was saying until after His resurrection.

He told Peter, "After you are converted, strengthen your brethren." Peter had been with Him, even in His temptation. After Peter received the new nature and the Holy Ghost, the Teacher would bring all things to his remembrance.

That holds true now. The Holy Ghost is still my Teacher. The more I pray in tongues, the more revelation I understand.

The disciples of John asked why Jesus' disciples did not fast. Jesus said, "They will fast when I am taken away." Then He immediately gave the reason.

Jesus continued:

No man putteth a piece of new cloth unto an old garment...

And:

Neither do men put new wine into old bottles: else the bottles break, and the wine runneth out...

Most people lift these verses out of context and make them fair game for almost anything. They say, "You cannot pour the new wine of the Holy Spirit into me until I am born again." That sounds good, but Jesus was answering their question about fasting.

The disciples asked, "Why do Your disciples not fast?" Jesus said, "When I am taken away, they will fast." Then He said, "You do not put new cloth on an old garment or new wine into old wineskins."

He did not change the subject. He was telling them why they would fast when He was taken away.

The only reason He said you do not put new wine into old bottles is that this is exactly what was about to happen. Your spirit would be seated with Him in heavenly places, as He is, so are we in this world. But He would leave you in the old garment, the old wineskin.

Unfortunately, your spirit is seated with Him, but you are still in the old body. If you have not noticed, get a mirror.

So fasting has the same effect on the old garment and old wineskin as if you had gone out and gotten a new one. It mortifies it by executing the position it has been declared to have: dead. As far as the carnal appetites of the flesh, complacency, indifference, and throwing your life away are concerned, fasting executes the flesh's inability to reign over your spirit.

Isaiah 58 says that the day you decide to fast is the day you decide to stop hiding from your own flesh. You decide that whatever is in you that does not care, you are not going to hide from it anymore.

God may bring you to the place where you are a blubbering, crying baby looking at your own life. He says, "Good, My child. When your old wineskin was that weak, how could I successfully pour out an entire operation of new wine? It would burst and pour out in front of the whole world."

We have seen old wineskins break. Had we known more about how to deal with the old wineskin, maybe we would have lost fewer people.

The new nature would appreciate you mortifying the wineskin so the new wine can come forward.

I was not taught this by flesh and blood. I was taught by my Teacher, who carries the promise and continues to. The truth I desire from Him now is how to take what He has given me and finish my course with the fullness of heaven's glories living here with us in our meetings.

Fasting mortifies your old wineskin and fortifies it while the new wine operates in it until the trumpet sounds. Then, in the twinkling of an eye, the same grace that brought your spirit from death to life will give you a glorified body that operates in harmony with your new nature.

Meanwhile, we receive a great reward for overcoming the flesh and dragging a few million people home with us. We receive a great reward for refusing to take no for the miracles so needed, especially by children, and for settling for nothing less than what He said we are.